Theorazine - the Conspiracy Calculator

Conspiracy Theory Name

e.g. Moon Landing Hoax

Brief Description

Describe the conspiracy theory...

📈Results

Probability of Remaining Secret

50%

Calculating...

Likelihood it Would Have Been Exposed Already

50%

The mathematical likelihood this secret has already leaked

Maximum Amount of Time It Could Have Stayed Secret

10 years

When the probability of remaining secret drops to 50%

📉Visualizations

Probability Gauge



Probability Decay Over Time

Comparison with Historical Examples

🧠How It Works

This calculator is based on **Dr. David Robert Grimes'** mathematical model from his 2016 paper *"On the Viability of Conspiratorial Beliefs"* published in PLOS ONE.

The Core Formula

$$P(t) = e^{-p \times N \times t}$$

- **P(t)** = Probability the conspiracy survives unexposed for time t
- **p** = Probability per year that each conspirator will leak
- **N** = Number of conspirators
- **t** = Time in years

The model shows that as the number of conspirators increases, or as time passes, the probability of maintaining secrecy decreases *exponentially*.

Profession-Based Leak Rates

Dr. Grimes analyzed real conspiracies to estimate how often people in different professions leak secrets:

- **Intelligence Workers:** 0.0003 per year (most secretive)
- **Scientists/Researchers:** 0.0004 per year
- **Military Personnel:** 0.0004 per year
- **Government Bureaucrats:** 0.0005 per year
- **Corporate Employees:** 0.0006 per year

- **General Public:** 0.001 per year (least secretive)

🤐Why Secrets Fail

Humans Suck at Keeping Secrets

Even trained professionals with security clearances leak information. Consider:

- **Bill Clinton** couldn't keep an affair with an intern secret in the Oval Office with the world's best intelligence agencies protecting him
- **Edward Snowden** - Single NSA contractor exposed massive surveillance programs
- **WikiLeaks** - One Army private (Chelsea Manning) leaked 750,000 classified documents
- **Watergate** - A burglary with a few conspirators toppled a presidency

The Math is Brutal

With large-scale conspiracies:

- 1,000 people keeping a secret for 5 years? Probability: **~13%**
- 10,000 people for 10 years? Probability: **< 0.01%**
- 100,000 people for 20 years? Probability: **Effectively zero**

Why This Matters

Extraordinary claims require extraordinary evidence. When a conspiracy theory requires thousands of people to maintain perfect silence for decades, the mathematics of human behavior makes it virtually impossible.

📚Historical Examples

Real conspiracies that **failed** to stay secret, despite small numbers and short durations:

Guy Fawkes Gunpowder Plot (1605)

Conspirators: 14

Duration Before Exposure: 1.5 years

Outcome: Discovered via anonymous letter before it could be carried out

Rajneeshee Bioterror Attack (1984)

Conspirators: 12-19

Duration Before Exposure: 1 year

Outcome: 751 people poisoned with salmonella; exposed through investigation

Downing Street Memo (2002)

Conspirators: 23

Duration Before Exposure: 3 years

Outcome: British government's Iraq War intelligence fixing leaked to journalists

> ***Note:*** *All of these involved fewer than 25 people and were exposed within 3 years. Large-scale conspiracies involving thousands of people for decades are mathematically implausible.*

ℹ️ About This Tool

Purpose

Conspiracy Theorazine is an educational tool designed to promote critical thinking about conspiracy theories. It uses peer-reviewed mathematical models to estimate whether large-scale conspiracies could realistically remain secret.

Limitations

- This is a **probabilistic model**, not a definitive truth detector
- Real-world factors like compartmentalization, fear, or incentives can affect leak rates
- Small conspiracies (< 10 people) can sometimes stay hidden for years
- The model assumes conspirators are aware of their participation

Credits

- **Mathematical Model:** Dr. David Robert Grimes (PLOS ONE paper)
- **Inspiration:** James Beach's essay "Conspiracy Theorazine"
- **Implementation:** Open source project (GitHub)

Disclaimer

This tool is for educational and entertainment purposes. While based on peer-reviewed research, it should not be considered the final word on any particular conspiracy theory. Critical thinking, evidence evaluation, and healthy skepticism should always guide belief formation.

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